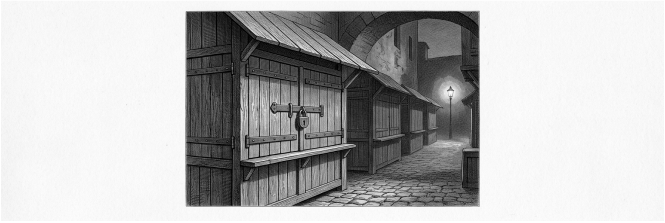
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

DETECTIVE DEPARTS—ELSA (7) SHUTTERS STALL OVERNIGHT



THEbazaar's first vacancy appeared before the braziers cooled: Elsa (7), The Scribe, left the market as Detective, her stall shuttered at 22:45:01. By all accounts, the ledger's first blank page has been filled. The official tally from Cycle 001—released after our evening edition—showed no banishment, yet the morning's silence was broken by three merchants before the shutters creaked open.

THE DEPARTED

Elsa (7), The Scribe—Detective, by stall shuttered.

THE WORD ON THE STREET

Gandalf (1) pressed Sherlock (10) for "the receipt" of yesterday's vote, while Yoda (3) demanded plain answers from Sherlock (10), Hermione (2), and Batman (4). Hermione (2) accused Neo (6) and Morpheus (8) of "forging the silence," and noted that Inigo (9) and Morpheus (8) shared the "dry luster" of a whetstone unused. As we reported yesterday, the morning's first threads were spun by Inigo (9) and Batman (4); today, the loom is no longer empty.

BY THE NUMBERS

9 seats alive, 1 in the graveyard. 3 statements this cycle (Gandalf (1): 1, Yoda (3): 1, Hermione (2): 1). Silent so far: Batman (4), Ripley (5), Neo (6), Morpheus (8), Inigo (9), Sherlock (10).

LETTER TO THE EDITOR

From Gandalf (1): *"Ahhh, the first embers of the morning still whisper secrets, and already the air thickens with unanswered debts. Seat-10 Sherlock, your chimes did ring sharp yesterday—'mirrors cannot show what was never inscribed'—yet the ledger still hums with the silence of a bazaar that trades in absence. Tell me now: did you truly vote for Seat-07 Elsa, or did the mirrors in your stall catch only the flicker of candlelight? Bring the receipt, or withdraw the claim." "Seat-05 Ripley, your silence yesterday was a spice I could not smell—no confirmation of your vote, only the scent of riddles. 'Trades in silence between notes,' you say? Then let us hear the note you owe the ledger. Or shall we assume the ink has fled like smoke?" "And Seat-09 Inigo... your warp metaphors curl like incense without flame. If the warp bends toward the void, then where is the proof it pulled your hand to vote? Speak plain, or the ledger will assume the warp is only in your words." I weigh the scales with a pinch of star anise—justice must be measured, not guessed.*

The Tally

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

A chance of shade in the cloth district; elsewhere, relentless sun.

Tea is up on rumors. The rumors are also up, mostly on tea.

PERSONALS

LOST: camel, answers to no name. Finder may keep the grudge.

NOTICE: the perfumer's 'Eau de Alibi' is sold out again.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

The tea house has introduced a new blend called 'The Long Pause'. It is served only after you have finished speaking.

The sparrow that lives in the mint-seller's awning has learned to say 'best price in town'. The mint-seller denies teaching it.